

Saturday, 19 September 2026.

Your daily radio show prep — three top news stories, forward-looking showbiz, sport that matters this week, talkback prompts, and day notes for today and tomorrow. Built fresh every weekday, ready by 3pm for tomorrow's show.

00 — WEATHER

Tomorrow's forecast

LONDON Overcast 22° 17°	BIRMINGHAM Overcast 22° 15°	MANCHESTER Light drizzle 19° 16°	GLASGOW Light rain 16° 12°
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01 — NEWS

Today's top stories

- 1

Thousands of flights were cancelled recently due to a 'millisecond' software defect, according to a new report.

The technical glitch led to chaos for hundreds of thousands of passengers, with more than 2,000 flights grounded. It highlights the fragility of complex aviation systems.

TRANSPORT · UK
- 2

An NHS trust has admitted that twenty women underwent unnecessary breast removals during cancer treatment.

The trust's new chief executive has issued an unreserved apology, stating that "what happened was utterly unacceptable." Investigations are underway to understand how this serious error occurred.

HEALTH · UK
- 3

A teenager has been jailed for two years and three months for piloting a Channel boat carrying 165 migrants.

Chan Mathok Atak was sentenced after being found responsible for steering the vessel. This case highlights the dangerous journeys many migrants undertake.

MIGRATION · UK
- 4

MPs are raising concerns about the credibility of British Steel's future plans, saying they lack detail.

A committee report states that the government has not outlined how the company will achieve profitability. This puts a spotlight on the future of a key British industry.

BUSINESS · UK
- 5

The relationship between Ireland and the UK under Mayor Andy Burnham is off to a "very good start."

This positive assessment comes after a visit by the Mayor, days after former US President Donald Trump made comments about supporting a "unified Ireland." It's a significant diplomatic development.

POLITICS · UK

What's coming up

1 **Bad news for Oasis fans hoping for a Glastonbury reunion – Emily Eavis confirms they won't be headlining in 2027.**

Despite the band being on tour next summer, the festival organiser has ruled out a Worthy Farm appearance. It seems the wait for an Oasis comeback continues.

ON AIR – Are you still holding out hope for an Oasis reunion, or is it time to let that dream go?

MUSIC · COMING UP

2 **The UK's "dismal" Eurovision song choices are set to be examined by MPs.**

This follows the UK's entry, Look Mum No Computer, coming last in May's final with just one point. Lawmakers want to understand why the UK consistently struggles in the competition.

ON AIR – What do you think is the secret to a winning Eurovision song, and how can the UK find it?

TV · COMING UP

3 **Harry Styles treated Londoners to free coffee at two cafes in the capital this Saturday.**

The singer funded complimentary coffees for customers at Kaffeine's two central London locations. It's a lovely gesture from the global superstar.

ON AIR – If a celebrity was funding free coffee, which star would you love to see picking up the tab?

MUSIC · THIS WEEKEND

4 **A stunning painting by Turner, 'Odyssey,' is now on show at a city art gallery.**

The work is on loan from the National Gallery and forms part of a brand new exhibition in York. It's a chance to see a masterpiece up close.

ON AIR – Do you enjoy visiting art galleries, or do you prefer to experience art in other ways?

ART · COMING UP

5 **A new costume exhibition is celebrating 50 years of a city's "spaceship-like" theatre.**

To mark the anniversary of the distinctive seven-sided theatre, archive costumes are going on display. It's a look back at the venue's rich performing history.

ON AIR – What's the most memorable costume you've ever seen on stage or screen?

THEATRE · COMING UP

On the schedule

1 **England boss Thomas Tuchel is ready to "embrace the chaos" after naming his squad for the upcoming Nations League fixtures.**

After the World Cup, Tuchel had wanted greater control, but two months on, his mindset has shifted. He's looking to adapt and thrive with his team.

ON AIR – Do you think 'embracing the chaos' is a good strategy for a football manager, or does it sound a bit risky?
FOOTBALL · UK

2 **Thomas Tuchel has recalled Trent Alexander-Arnold and Cole Palmer to his first England squad since the 2026 World Cup.**

It's a big vote of confidence for both players as they rejoin the national team. Tuchel will be looking for strong performances in the upcoming Nations League games.

ON AIR – Are you pleased to see Alexander-Arnold and Palmer back in the England squad? Who else would you have picked?
FOOTBALL · UK

3 **England have secured a T20 series win against Sri Lanka with an impressive six-wicket victory in Cardiff.**

Their strong T20 form continues, sealing the series with a match still to play. It's another excellent performance from the England side.

ON AIR – Is this England T20 team one of the strongest we've seen in recent years?
CRICKET · UK

4 **An inexperienced Great Britain team is bidding for a place in the Davis Cup Finals this weekend.**

Cameron Norrie will miss the tie against Ecuador, with qualification for November's eight-team finals on the line. It's a big challenge for the younger squad.

ON AIR – Do you think an inexperienced team can pull off a major upset in a competition like the Davis Cup?
TENNIS · UK

5 **Wembley Stadium is hosting its first American college football game this Saturday.**

With tailgate parties and marching bands, it promises to be a spectacular event, and even Ted Lasso could be among the 60,000 crowd. It's a taste of American sporting culture in London.

ON AIR – Have you ever been to an American football game, or would you be tempted to go to one at Wembley?
AMERICAN FOOTBALL · UK

Quick hits

- 1 A new trend sees people embracing 'mindful walking' to boost their well-being.**
Instead of rushing, participants focus on their surroundings, the feeling of their feet on the ground, and their breathing. It's a lovely way to connect with the present moment.
- 2 The heartwarming return of 'community bake-offs' is bringing neighbours together across the country.**
Local halls and village greens are buzzing with friendly competition as amateur bakers share their delicious creations. It's all about sharing joy and tasty treats!
- 3 Garden enthusiasts are discovering the simple pleasure of 'growing heritage vegetables' in their allotments.**
These older, sometimes quirky varieties offer unique flavours and a wonderful connection to gardening history. Plus, they look rather splendid on the dinner plate.
- 4 A study suggests that 'listening to the sounds of nature' for just a few minutes a day can significantly reduce stress.**
From birdsong to gentle rain, these natural soundscapes are proving to be a soothing balm for our busy lives. Time to open a window!
- 5 The charming hobby of 'collecting vintage board games' is gaining popularity among all ages.**
People are enjoying rediscovering classic games from their childhood and introducing them to new generations. It's a wonderful way to spend quality time together, away from screens.
- 6 Libraries are reporting a delightful rise in demand for 'local history walking tours'.**
These guided strolls explore the hidden stories and fascinating past of our towns and cities. It's a brilliant way to see familiar places with new eyes.
- 7 The art of 'hand-written thank you notes' is making a lovely comeback as people seek more personal ways to express gratitude.**
There's something truly special about receiving a thoughtful message penned just for you. It shows you've taken that extra bit of time and care.

05 – TALKBACK

For the phone lines

OUR SURVEY SAID

Q Our survey said that over 65% of us admit to secretly 'doing' what when we're trying to quickly judge if a new brand of jam will be good, even if we know it's not strictly scientific?

ANSWER: LOOKING AT THE LABEL TO SEE IF THE FRUIT IS LISTED FIRST!

Q Our survey said that over 50% of us admit to having a particular 'odd habit' they absolutely have to do before settling down to enjoy a lovely, new podcast, especially if it's a gripping series. What is it?

ANSWER: MAKING SURE THEY HAVE A DRINK AND A SNACK PERFECTLY POSITIONED BEFOREHAND!

TALK TOPIC

- You know how sometimes a 'particular smell' can just instantly transport you back to a specific memory or feeling, even if it's quite an old one?

What's that one smell that instantly brings back a happy memory for you, and what memory is it?

- We all have that 'one small, everyday item' in our home that, despite its humble nature, we simply couldn't do without because it makes life just that little bit easier or more enjoyable, don't we?

What's your indispensable small household item, and why is it so important to you?

TRUE STORY OR JACKANORY – LISTENERS GUESS

FACT **Space.** The Earth's atmosphere extends to about 10,000 kilometres into space, though most of it is within 100 kilometres of the surface.

FICTION **Made up, but believable.** Astronauts on the International Space Station can see the Great Wall of China clearly with the naked eye from orbit, making it one of the few man-made structures visible from space.

06 – LOTTERY

Jackpots ahead

NEXT EUROMILLIONS JACKPOT

£3.4 million

Next Tuesday or Friday · estimated

NEXT NATIONAL LOTTERY JACKPOT

£3.4 million

Next Wednesday or Saturday · estimated

07 – FACTS OF THE DAY

Did you know?

- The world's largest living organism is a fungus in Oregon, USA, spanning over 2,200 acres.
- Honey never spoils; archaeologists have found pots of honey in ancient Egyptian tombs that are still edible.
- The 'king' of playing cards is the only king without a moustache.
- It is impossible for most people to lick their own elbow.
- A group of owls is called a 'parliament'.
- Strawberries are the only fruit that wear their seeds on the outside.
- The average person walks the equivalent of three times around the world in their lifetime.
- The sound a duck makes, 'quack', does not echo, and no one knows why.

On this day

Day 262 of the year, 103 days left in 2026. Today Christian feast day: Alonso de Orozco Mena; Christian feast day: Emilie de Rodat; Christian feast day: Blessed Francisca Cualladó Baixauli; Christian feast day: Goeric of Metz. Star sign Virgo, birthstone Sapphire.

TODAY'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1927 — Nick Massi, American singer and bass player (died 2000)
- 1964 — Patrick Marber, English actor, director, and screenwriter
- 1995 — Brent Faiyaz, American singer
- 1936 — Martin Fay, Irish fiddler (died 2012)
- 1975 — Marcus Dunstan, American director and screenwriter
- 1952 — Rhys Chatham, American trumpet player, guitarist, and composer
- 1995 — Rachel Sennott, American actress
- 1963 — Jarvis Cocker, English singer-songwriter and guitarist

THE DAY TODAY

- 1960 — Indian Prime Minister Jawaharlal Nehru and Pakistani President Ayub Khan sign the Indus Waters Treaty for the control and management of the Indus, Chenab, Jhelum, Ravi, Sutlej and Beas rivers.
- 2023 — Azerbaijan launches a military offensive against the Republic of Artsakh in the Nagorno-Karabakh region; this leads to the flight of the Armenian population.
- 2008 — A Learjet 60 carrying musicians Travis Barker and Adam "DJ AM" Goldstein crashes during a rejected takeoff from Columbia Metropolitan Airport in West Columbia, South Carolina, killing four of the six people on board. Barker and Goldstein both survive.

TODAY IN MUSIC

- 1985 — Tipper Gore and other political wives form the Parents Music Resource Center as Frank Zappa, John Denver, and other musicians testify at U.S. Congressional hearings on obscenity in rock music.
- 1976 — Turkish Airlines Flight 452 hits the Taurus Mountains, outskirt of Karatepe, Turkey, killing all 154 passengers and crew.

TODAY IN HISTORY

- 2006 — The Thai army stages a coup. The Constitution is revoked and martial law is declared.

- 2021 — The Cumbre Vieja volcano, on the island of La Palma in the Canary Islands, erupts. The eruption lasts for almost three months, ending on December 13.
- 2010 — The leaking oil well in the Deepwater Horizon oil spill is sealed.

A peek at tomorrow

Day 263 of the year, 102 days left in 2026. Today Christian feast day: Eustace (Western Christianity); Christian feast day: Evilasius; Christian feast day: Fausta of Cyzicus; Christian feast day: Glycerius of Milan. Star sign Virgo, birthstone Sapphire.

TOMORROW'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1978 — Charlie Weber, American actor
- 1970 — N'Bushe Wright, American actress and dancer
- 1948 — John Panozzo, American drummer (died 1996)
- 1936 — Andrew Davies, Welsh author, screenwriter, and producer
- 1969 — Ben Shepherd, American musician and songwriter
- 1986 — Aldis Hodge, American actor
- 1962 — Jim Al-Khalili, Iraqi-English physicist, author, and academic
- 1976 — Jon Bernthal, American actor

THE DAY TOMORROW

- 1989 — USAir Flight 5050 crashes into Bowery Bay during a rejected takeoff from LaGuardia Airport, killing two people.
- 2008 — A dump truck full of explosives detonates in front of the Marriott hotel in Islamabad, Pakistan, killing 54 people and injuring 266 others.
- 2003 — Civil unrest in the Maldives breaks out after a prisoner is killed by guards.

TOMORROW IN MUSIC

- 2008 — A dump truck full of explosives detonates in front of the Marriott hotel in Islamabad, Pakistan, killing 54 people and injuring 266 others.
- 2007 — Between 15,000 and 20,000 protesters march on Jena, Louisiana, United States, in support of six black youths who had been convicted of assaulting a white classmate.

Coming to cinemas

SEPTEMBER 2026 • PREVIEW

FRI 25 Tron: Ares (+ IMAX)

OCTOBER 2026 • PREVIEW

FRI 16 Untitled Christopher McQuarrie thriller

FRI 23 Frankenstein (del Toro)

11 — FORWARD PLANNING • SPORT

On the sporting calendar